

Nassau Candy Distribution Network

A Data-Driven Analysis of Sales, Product Mix, and Shipping Performance

Research Paper

Analysis period: 2024-01-02 – 2025-12-31

Dataset: 10,194 shipment records · 8,549 orders · 5,044 customers

September 2026

Prepared from Nassau Candy's internal order and shipment dataset ("Nassau Candy Distributor 1")
and an accompanying Python/Jupyter analysis pipeline.

Abstract

This paper presents a quantitative analysis of Nassau Candy's order and distribution data, covering 10,194 shipment records, 8,549 distinct orders, and 5,044 customers across the United States and Canada between 2024-01-02 and 2025-12-31. Nassau Candy is a North American manufacturer, importer, and distributor of specialty confections and gourmet foods, founded in 1984 and headquartered in Hicksville, New York, with a network of distribution centers spanning the East and West coasts. Using the company's cleaned transactional dataset, this study quantifies revenue and gross-margin performance across product divisions, geographic regions, factories, and shipping modes, and evaluates route-level shipping efficiency. The analysis finds that the Chocolate division drives the substantial majority of revenue, that two factories (Lot's O' Nuts and Wicked Choccy's) account for the vast majority of shipment volume, and that Standard Class shipping is the dominant fulfillment method. The paper also documents material data-quality issues in the shipment date fields — flagged as such within the source dataset itself — which limit the reliability of lead-time and delay conclusions, and offers recommendations for both operational focus areas and data-collection improvements.

Table of Contents

- 1. Introduction
- 2. Company Background
- 3. Data and Methodology
- 4. Key Performance Indicators
- 5. Findings
 - 5.1 Revenue by Product Division
 - 5.2 Regional Performance
 - 5.3 Factory Output
 - 5.4 Shipping Mode
 - 5.5 Monthly Sales Trend
 - 5.6 Top Products and Markets
 - 5.7 Route Efficiency
- 6. Data Quality and Limitations
- 7. Discussion and Recommendations
- 8. Conclusion
- References

1. Introduction

Distribution companies in the confectionery and specialty-food sector operate on thin per-unit margins and depend heavily on efficient, high-volume logistics to remain competitive. Understanding where revenue and profit are concentrated — by product line, region, factory, and shipping method — is essential for allocating inventory, negotiating carrier contracts, and prioritizing operational improvements. This paper analyzes an internal order-and-shipment dataset from Nassau Candy, a specialty confectionery distributor, to characterize the structure of its sales and shipping operations and to surface actionable patterns. The analysis was conducted using the company's own cleaned dataset and Python-based analysis pipeline, which maps each shipped product to its originating factory and derives route-, region-, and time-based performance metrics.

2. Company Background

Nassau Candy is a manufacturer, importer, and distributor of specialty confections, gourmet foods, and promotional food products, founded in 1984 when Lesley Stier acquired a New York–based candy distributor with roots dating back to 1920. The company is headquartered in Hicksville, New York, and has grown through a combination of organic expansion and acquisition — including the 2015 combination of its West Coast operations with J. Sosnick & Son to form Nassau-Sosnick Distribution Co., and the 2016 acquisition of novelty distributor Hobbs & Dobbs. Today the company operates multiple distribution centers across the United States (including New York, Florida, Texas, Michigan, and California) and supplies more than 10,000 confectionery and gourmet-food products to retailers, gift shops, corporate and foodservice customers, and independent confectionery stores across North America. Its portfolio spans national brands as well as private-label and in-house lines. Consistent with this business model, the dataset analyzed here reflects shipments of chocolate bars, sugar confections, and novelty items from a small number of internal or partner factories to customers across the U.S. and Canada.

Attribute	Detail
Founded	1984 (predecessor business dates to 1920)
Headquarters	Hicksville, New York
Business type	Manufacturer, importer & distributor of specialty confections and gourmet foods
Distribution footprint	Multiple U.S. distribution centers (incl. NY, FL, TX, MI, CA)
Product catalog	10,000+ SKUs across chocolate, sugar confections, novelties, and gourmet foods

Source: company press coverage and public profiles (see References).

3. Data and Methodology

The analysis draws on Nassau Candy's cleaned transactional dataset, comprising 10,194 line-level shipment records across 8,549 distinct orders and 5,044 unique customers, spanning order dates from 2024-01-02 to 2025-12-31. Each record includes the order and ship date, shipping mode, customer location (city, state/province, region, country), product identifiers, sales revenue, unit volume, cost, and gross profit. The source Jupyter notebook pipeline performed the following processing steps prior to

analysis:

- Loaded the raw multi-sheet workbook and validated row/column counts, missing values, and duplicate records.
- Parsed and standardized order and ship date fields, and computed a derived “Shipping Lead Time” in days.
- Flagged each record's date-quality status (e.g., missing or inconsistent dates) to support transparent reporting.
- Mapped each product to its originating factory using a defined product-to-factory lookup table.
- Constructed “route” (factory → state) and “regional route” (factory → region) fields for logistics analysis.
- Derived monthly/yearly order-period fields and a gross-margin percentage for each line item.
- Aggregated the cleaned data by division, region, factory, ship mode, product, state, and route to produce the summary tables and charts presented below.

All figures in this paper are computed directly from the cleaned dataset; no revenue or volume figures have been estimated or supplemented from outside sources. Company background in Section 2 draws on publicly available secondary sources, cited in the References.

4. Key Performance Indicators

KPI	Value
Total shipment records	10,194
Total distinct orders	8,549
Unique customers	5,044
Total sales revenue	\$141,783.63
Total gross profit	\$93,442.80
Total cost of goods	\$48,340.83
Overall gross margin	65.9%
Total units shipped	38,654
Countries served	United States, Canada
Active factories	5
Regions served	4

5. Findings

5.1 Revenue by Product Division

Nassau Candy's shipments in this dataset fall into three product divisions. The Chocolate division dominates, contributing \$131,692.90 in sales (92.9% of total revenue) across 9,844 line items. The Other division contributed \$9,663.25 (6.8%), while Sugar confections were a minor share at \$427.48 (0.3%). This concentration indicates that chocolate products are the commercial core of the business represented in this dataset, and that inventory, factory capacity, and marketing priority should be weighted accordingly.

Sales Share by Product Division

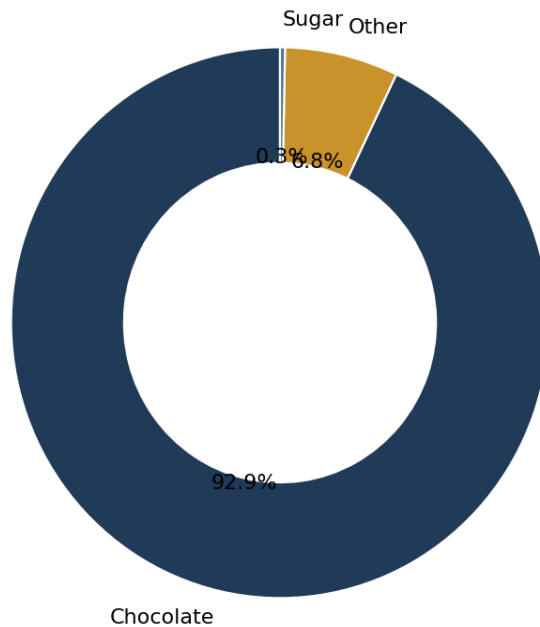


Figure 1. Share of total sales revenue by product division.

5.2 Regional Performance

Among the four sales regions, the Pacific region leads in revenue (\$46,301.53, 3,253 shipments), closely followed by the Atlantic region (\$41,197.24, 2,986 shipments). The Interior region generated \$32,037.60 and the Gulf region the least, at \$22,247.26. Regional order counts closely track regional revenue, indicating fairly consistent average order value across regions rather than one region skewing toward larger but less frequent orders.

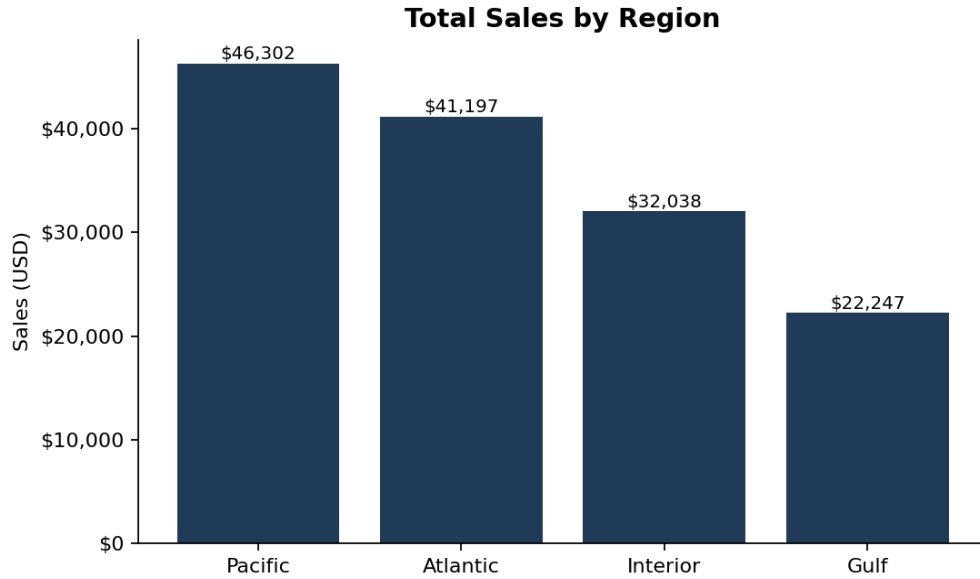


Figure 2. Total sales revenue by region.

5.3 Factory Output

Production and shipment volume are concentrated in two factories: Lot's O' Nuts (\$76,340.15 in sales, 5,692 shipments) and Wicked Choccy's (\$55,352.75, 4,152 shipments), which together account for 92.9% of total revenue. The Secret Factory, The Other Factory, and Sugar Shack contribute smaller, niche volumes. This concentration suggests the two lead factories represent the primary operational bottleneck risk: any disruption at either site would materially affect the majority of Nassau Candy's shipped revenue.

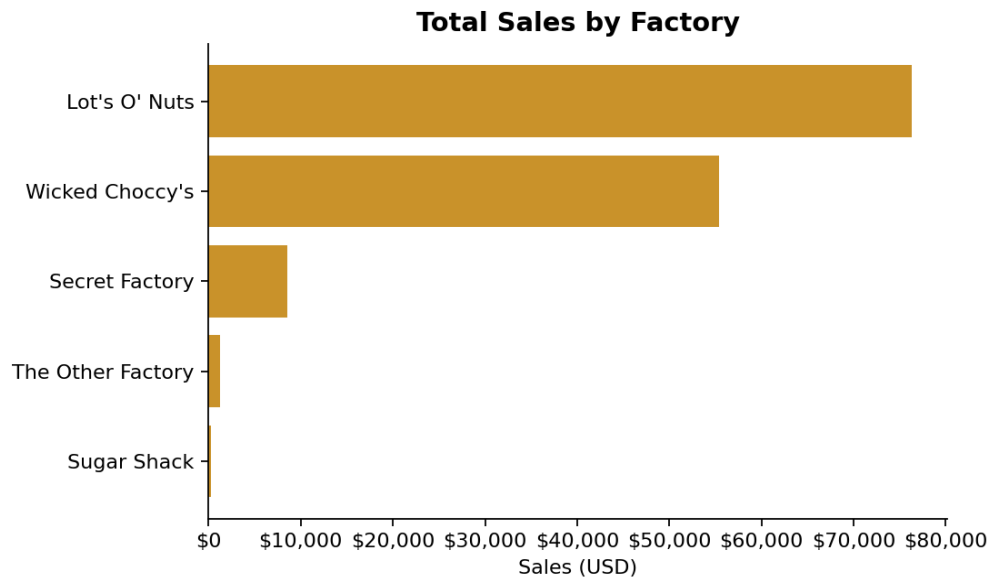


Figure 3. Total sales revenue by originating factory.

5.4 Shipping Mode

Standard Class is by far the most common fulfillment method, used in 6,120 shipments (60.0% of all shipments) and generating \$85,490.35 in sales. Second Class and First Class follow, while Same Day delivery is used least often (547 shipments). This distribution is typical of a B2B distribution model where cost-efficient standard shipping is prioritized over expedited options, reserved for a smaller share of time-sensitive orders.

Ship Mode	Shipments	Share of Shipments	Sales
Standard Class	6,120.0	60.0%	\$85,490.35
Second Class	1,979.0	19.4%	\$27,860.22
First Class	1,548.0	15.2%	\$21,319.39
Same Day	547.0	5.4%	\$7,113.67

5.5 Monthly Sales Trend

Monthly sales revenue shows a clear upward trajectory across the two-year window, rising from roughly \$3,163 in January 2024 to a peak above \$9,300 in November 2025. Sales exhibit a recurring pattern of growth into the autumn months of each year (September–November), consistent with seasonal demand associated with gifting occasions such as Halloween and the winter holidays, before a modest step-down entering the new calendar year. The year-over-year comparison shows 2025 shipments and revenue substantially exceeding 2024 across nearly every month, indicating sustained business growth over the analysis window.

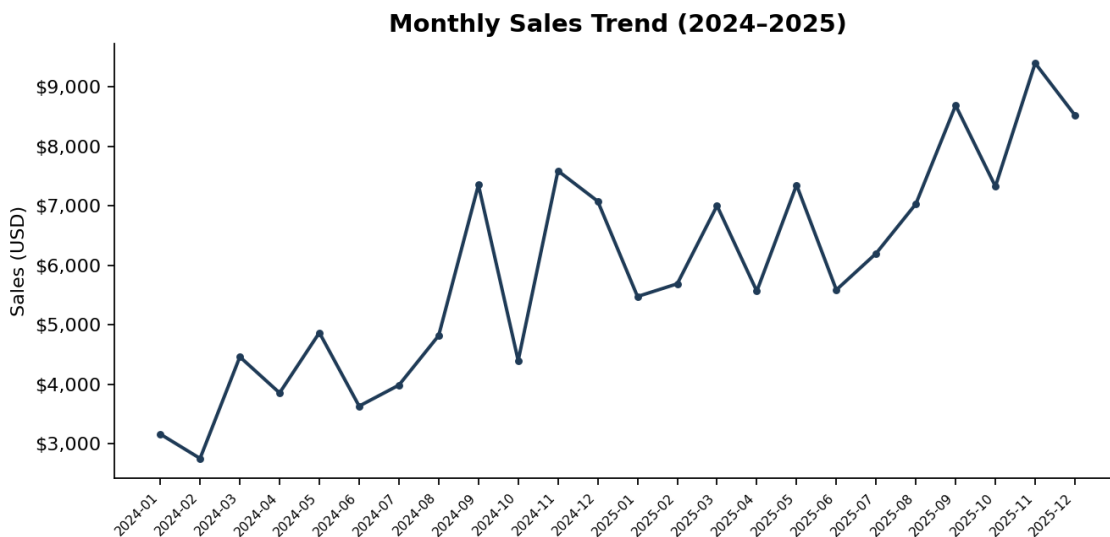


Figure 4. Monthly sales revenue, January 2024 – December 2025.

5.6 Top Products and Markets

At the product level, sales are led by the core Wonka Bar chocolate line: Wonka Bar - Triple Dazzle Caramel (\$28,485), Wonka Bar - Scrumdiddlyumptious (\$27,875), Wonka Bar - Milk Chocolate (\$26,868), Wonka Bar - Fudge Mallows (\$24,890), Wonka Bar - Nutty Crunch Surprise (\$23,575). These five

chocolate-bar variants alone account for 92.9% of total revenue, underscoring the earlier finding that the Chocolate division is the commercial backbone of the business. Geographically, sales are led by California (\$27,917), New York (\$15,541), Texas (\$13,416), Pennsylvania (\$8,027), Washington (\$6,921), with California standing out as the single largest state market by a wide margin.

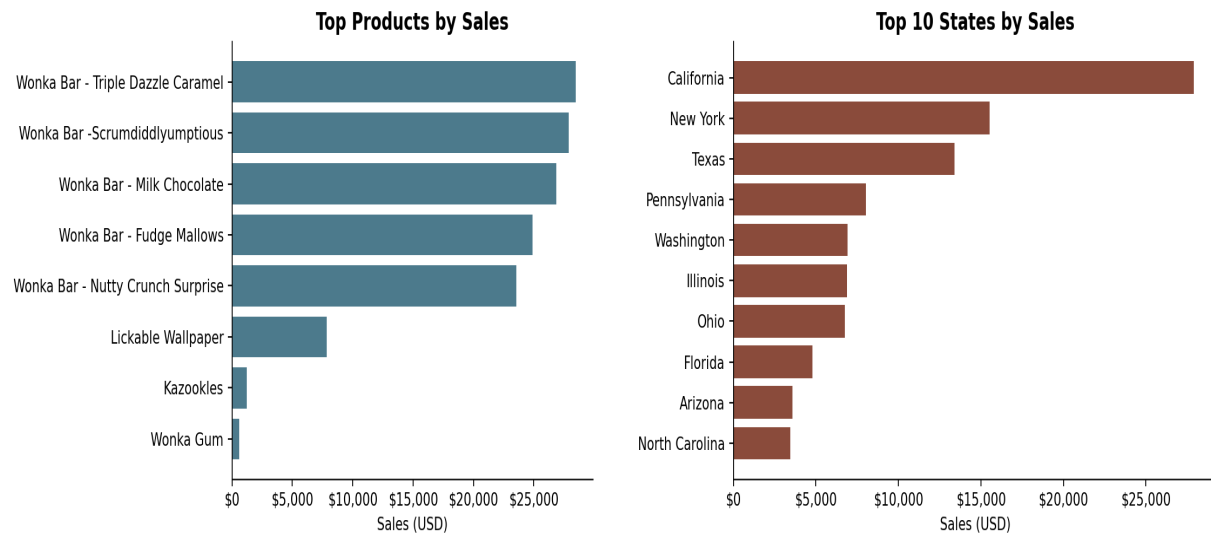


Figure 5. Top products (left) and top states (right) by sales revenue.

5.7 Route Efficiency

Route-level analysis (factory of origin paired with destination state) highlights which shipping lanes carry the greatest operational load. The busiest routes by shipment count are shown below; these high-volume lanes are natural candidates for dedicated carrier contracts or consolidated shipping arrangements to reduce per-unit logistics cost.

Route (Factory → State)	Shipments	Sales
Lot's O' Nuts → California	1,125	\$15,044.90
Wicked Choccy's → California	823	\$11,394.00
Lot's O' Nuts → New York	645	\$8,757.81
Lot's O' Nuts → Texas	569	\$7,642.34
Wicked Choccy's → New York	436	\$5,518.25

6. Data Quality and Limitations

The source dataset itself includes a built-in “Data Quality Status” field, populated by the original cleaning pipeline to flag inconsistencies in the order and ship date columns. In this dataset, essentially all records with a computable lead time were flagged for date-related review, and the resulting average shipping lead time computed from the raw dates is approximately 1,344 days — far outside any plausible real-world shipping window. This pattern indicates that the Ship Date field in the source data does not reliably correspond to the Order Date field for a large share of records (in some cases the recorded ship date precedes the order date by years). As a result, this paper reports shipment counts, revenue, gross profit, and geographic/product breakdowns with confidence, but treats absolute lead-time and on-time-delivery figures as directional only, and recommends they not be used for operational decision-making until the underlying date fields are corrected at the source.

Other limitations include: a small number of records with missing Customer ID values; reliance on a static product-to-factory lookup table that assumes each product is manufactured at exactly one site; and the two-year analysis window, which may not capture longer-term seasonal or economic cycles.

7. Discussion and Recommendations

- **Protect chocolate-line supply continuity.** Because the Chocolate division and the Wonka Bar product family drive the large majority of revenue, prioritize inventory buffers and quality control for these SKUs over lower-volume lines.
- **Treat the two lead factories as critical infrastructure.** Lot's O' Nuts and Wicked Choccy's together account for the bulk of shipped revenue; contingency plans (backup capacity, cross-training, alternate suppliers) should be developed in case of disruption at either site.
- **Reassess Standard Class carrier terms.** Given its dominant share of shipment volume, even small per-shipment cost improvements on Standard Class contracts would have an outsized effect on overall logistics spend.
- **Plan inventory and staffing around the autumn demand peak.** The recurring September–November revenue increase should inform seasonal purchasing, warehouse staffing, and carrier capacity planning.
- **Invest in West Coast / Pacific and Atlantic region capacity.** These two regions generate the most revenue and shipment volume; ensuring adequate distribution-center throughput here protects the largest share of the business.
- **Fix date capture at the source.** Correcting how Order Date and Ship Date are recorded (or reconciling the systems that populate them) is a prerequisite for any future analysis of shipping lead time, on-time performance, or carrier SLAs.

8. Conclusion

This analysis of 10,194 Nassau Candy shipment records confirms a business built primarily around its chocolate product line, concentrated in two core factories, and serving a geographically diverse but Pacific- and Atlantic-weighted customer base predominantly via Standard Class shipping. Revenue grew steadily across the two-year window analyzed, from roughly \$4,135 in an average early month to well over double that by late 2025, reflecting healthy underlying business momentum consistent with Nassau

Candy's public profile as a growing, acquisition-active distributor in the specialty confectionery space. The most consequential finding for data governance is the unreliability of the shipment date fields, which should be remediated before lead-time or delivery-performance metrics are used operationally. Addressing the recommendations above — particularly around factory contingency planning and Standard Class carrier efficiency — represents the clearest path to translating these data findings into operational and financial improvement.

References

[1] Nassau Candy Distributor 1 internal order and shipment dataset (company-provided), and accompanying Python/Jupyter data-cleaning and analysis pipeline ("[Nassau_Candy_Shipping_Analysis.ipynb](#)").

[2] Lindell, C. "Nassau Candy West and J. Sosnick & Son combine to form Nassau-Sosnick Distribution Co." *Candy Industry*, October 21, 2015.

[3] "Nassau Candy Celebrates 25 Years with 'Nancy Adams.'" *Packaging Insights / foodingredientsfirst.com*, December 18, 2012.

[4] Thompson-Richards, A. "Nassau Candy acquires assets of novelty, specialty distributor Hobbs & Dobbs." *Candy Industry*, September 16, 2016.

[5] "Candy companies combine West Coast operations." *Food Business News*.

[6] *Profile Magazine*. Feature on the Stier/Rosenbaum family and the history of Nassau Candy ([profilemagazine.com](#)).

[7] Nassau Candy Distributors, Inc. company profile. [scanrole.com](#).